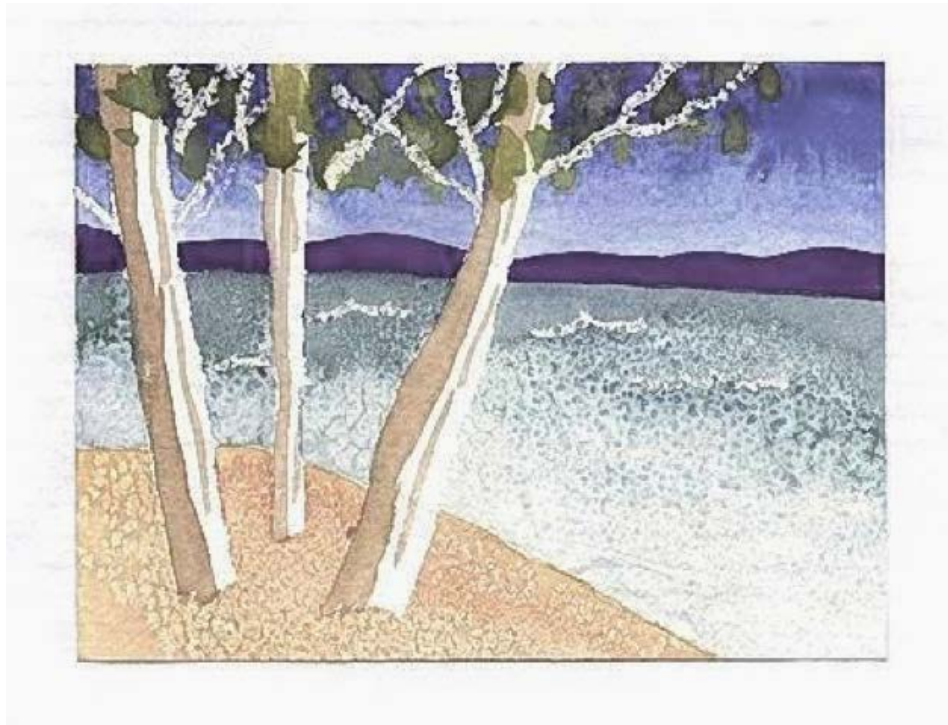




Watercolor Seascapes

Grade 3

Watercolor



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www.losaltosartdocents.org

Last Revised: June 2024

WATERCOLOR SEASCAPES

Length: 90 minutes

Number of docents: 2

Purpose:

- To introduce students to new watercolor techniques: color mixing in a palette, masking tape and wax resist, graded wash, and salt techniques. Brush strokes include stipple stroke and pull stroke.
- To introduce the art element of space/perspective including foreground, middleground and background.
- To introduce students to the art element of color/value and how to use it to create mood and depth perspective in a painting.
- To mix primary colors to make secondary colors

Visual Arts Standards:

- Apply knowledge of available resources, tools, and technologies to investigate personal ideas through the art-making process. (3.VA:Cr1.2)
- Create personally satisfying artwork using a variety of artistic processes and materials. (3.VA:Cr2.1)
- Demonstrate an understanding of the safe and proficient use of materials, tools, and equipment for a variety of artistic processes. (3.VA:Cr2.2)
- Individually or collaboratively construct representations, diagrams, or maps of places that are part of everyday life. (3.VA:Cr2.3)
- Discuss, reflect, and add details to enhance an artwork's emerging meaning. (3.VA:Cr3)
- Determine messages communicated by an image. (3.VA:Re7.2)
- Interpret art by analyzing use of media to create subject matter, characteristics of form, and mood. (3.VA:Re8)
- Evaluate an artwork based on given criteria. (3.VA:Re9)

Unit Contains: Supply box and portfolio

Materials docent will bring:

- one 3"x 11" piece of watercolor paper per student to try out colors
- one 7 ½"x11" piece of watercolor paper per student
- WIDE (1-1/2" or 2") masking tape
- White Caran d'Ache
- Salt shakers

- #10 brushes
- Watercolor refills (red, blue, yellow)
- Droppers for docents/parents

Materials teacher will provide per student:

- 1 box of Prang watercolor paints. Please make sure there is true RED, YELLOW, and BLUE in the paint box.
- 1 non-breakable water container
- Paper towel
- Pencil (not mechanical)

Features works:

Nassau: Water and Sailboat, 1899

Winslow Homer

Setting of the Sun at Douarnenez, 1883

Pierre Auguste Renoir

Boats Below The Pourville Cliffs, 1882

Claude Monet

Room set-up:

Before setting up, check paint boxes for primary colors. Place on each student's desk:

- 1 7 ½" x 11" piece of watercolor paper
- 1 3"x5" pieces of watercolor paper (for trying out colors)
- 1 white Caran d'Ache
- Two 9" strips of masking tape (attach to edge of desk or back of chair)
- Salt shaker for every two students
- Upon sitting down, ask the students to place their pieces of masking tape on their clothes to help decrease the stickiness.

INTRODUCTION:

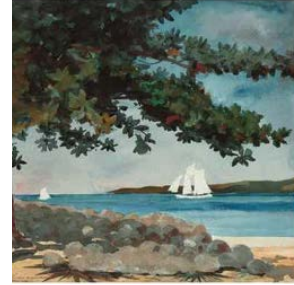
Today we will be painting a beautiful watercolor seascape. We will be using some fun techniques and talking about “**value**” - **lightness or darkness of a color**. We will be mixing our paints to get colors that help **create mood** and **depth perspective** in our paintings. (*Show samples*)

NASSAU: WATER AND SAILBOAT, 1899

Winslow Homer

Watercolor on paper

15” x 15”



BOATS BELOW THE POURVILLE CLIFFS, 1882

Claude Monet

Oil on canvas

26” x 32”



THE SETTING OF THE SUN AT DOUARNENEZ, 1883

Pierre Auguste Renoir

Oil on canvas

21” x 25”



We have some beautiful paintings from some very famous artists for inspiration. Let’s take a look at them. What is the same? (*They are all seascapes*) What is different? (*colors of water and skies, one is a sunset, two have boats, one has a tree, etc.*)

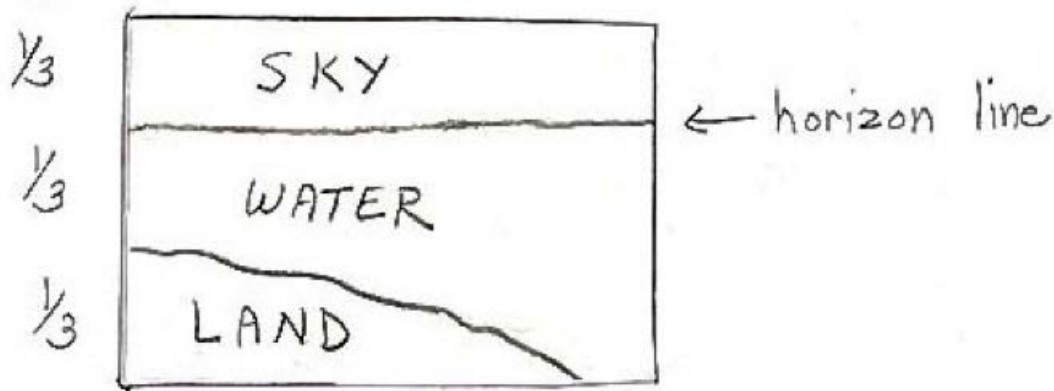
These prints all have **perspective**, which means some things look closer while others look farther away.

Claude Monet, Winslow Homer and Pierre August Renoir achieved this by using a foreground, middle ground, and background in their paintings. (*Choose one of the prints to point out the parts of a landscape/seascape*). The **foreground** includes the bottom of the paper with objects that are closest to us, the **middle ground** is between the foreground and **background** where the subject or action is taking place. The background is for objects that are farthest away.

We will be using this technique in our paintings today.

LANDSCAPE SECTIONS:

DRAW two lines to divide your paper into three sections – FOREGROUND, MIDDLE GROUND and BACKGROUND.



We will be using the lid of our paint box as a **PALLETTE** to mix our colors. The first thing we need to do is **PRIME** our paints. **PRIME** means to get ready. Have students prime their paints by loading their brush with 3-4 drops of water and squeezing the water onto the paints.

Instruct students on how to **clean their brushes** by first drying them on their paper towel, then dipping in water, then drying one more time. We want to keep our paints clean so our colors will be clean and true.

Ask students to name the **primary colors** (red, yellow and blue) and **secondary colors** (orange, purple, green). Why are the primary colors important? (they can't be made by mixing other colors). Ask which two primary colors are mixed to make orange (red & yellow), purple (blue & red) and green (blue & yellow).

TAPE RESIST: PLACEMENT for trees.

Ask students: **Where do you think we use the tape in our painting?**

After putting two pieces of tape on clothing to remove some of the adhesive (pick up and replace tape on clothing 3 times), have students tear the tape while it is still on their clothing. Instruct students to place the first tree trunk about an inch from the bottom of the page, making sure to extend the trunk off the top of the page. Next, ask students, “**Where would I place the second tree trunk to make it appear farther away?**” (*higher on the page from the first trunk*) and the third? (*students may use two or three trunks*).

Ask students: **What impression do you get when the trunks go off the top of the page?** (*the trees are very tall*).



WAX RESIST:

Ask students: **Where do you think we use the white wax crayon in our paintings?**

Demonstrate how to use Caran d'Ache (*using medium pressure*) to draw birds, sailboat, whitecaps on waves and branches on trees. Draw on the white board with a marker as students will not be able to see the Caran d'Ache on their paper.

SKY: MIX COLORS TO MAKE A SUNSET, DRAMATIC OR PLEASANT DAY and apply paint horizontally. Show samples of a dramatic sky (blue plus a very small amount of purple), a pleasant day (blue plus water for a light sky) or a sunset (combination of yellow and orange and red). REFER to samples and prints.

OCEAN: MIX COLORS TO CREATE A DRAMATIC OR CALM SEA

Refer to samples. Use blue and yellow in different amounts to get the blue/green color of choice. Add water to make it **lighter if** you like. Use blue and green to achieve an aqua color like the Caribbean.

GRADED WASH/VALUE TECHNIQUE: Refer to prints and samples. Demonstrate how to paint a graded wash to create the illusion of depth. Darker colors represent areas in the sea where the water is deeper or plant life exists, lighter colors are along the shoreline where the water is shallow. The color values in the water are reflected from the color values of the sky.

Mix a color in your palette for the sky. Roll your brush in the paint to fill it thoroughly. Holding brush (like a toy car) pull color horizontally across top of paper in one stroke. Fill in about a third of the top of the ocean beneath the horizon line. Repeat by removing a bit of the pigment on a paper towel, dipping just the tip of the paintbrush in water and continue painting, adding water as necessary until you reach the shoreline.

Show students how to remove/erase paint by using a dry brush to pick up the paint.

SALT: SPRINKLE SALT gently near the shore to create bubbles and waves near the shore. DO NOT add paint over the salt or the technique won't work. Before using the salt shaker ask students to use their hand to practice in the air how they shake salt on their food. That's how we will sprinkle our salt today.

BEACH: MIX BROWN AND YELLOW (you can also add a tiny bit of orange) for a sandy color and paint beach, sprinkle SALT to create texture.

TREE TRUNKS: Carefully REMOVE TAPE and discuss POSITIVE (the area of a painting where the focus or action take place) and NEGATIVE SPACE empty space – puts the focus on the action or subject

SHADING TRUNKS: Use dirty water or paint to add a shadow to one side of tree trunks plus a few additional lines to create **an** illusion of a round tree. Discuss where the sun is in the samples.

LEAVES: use YELLOW paint for STIPPLE STROKES on tree tops. Use blue or red paint and stipple over yellow to get either orange or green leaves to indicate spring, summer or fall. If you use all three primaries the leaves will be brown, be careful.

MOUNTAINS: Lastly, use purple to create a mountain range being careful not to overlap into wet paint on tree trunks.

Parent Instructions for Watercolor Seascapes

Thank you for volunteering today!

Please help by:

Setting up lesson supplies

- Clear desks/tables
- Pass out watercolor paper with Art Docent stamp side up, 3" x 5" test paper, paper towel, brush, watercolor paints, ½ filled water container, white crayon
- Place two 9" strips of masking tape on edge of each desk or back of chair
- Dirty paint palettes can be wiped with a wet paper towel.



During the lesson

- Listen carefully to the docent instructions to the students
- Assist individual students by walking around the room
- Refresh water as needed
- Encourage students to use paint techniques shown
- Hand out salt shakers when needed, one for every two students
- Remind them that salt technique only works on wet areas and not to touch again after use
- Show students how to clean palettes using a clean wet brush and paper towel

Additional tips

- Please don't work on students' art — demonstrate on scrap materials
- Ask Art Docents if a student needs extra help
- Have fun!

Helping clean-up

- Clean brushes thoroughly by washing out excess paint in water
- Wipe out lid of paint palettes, clean with a paint brush if needed
- Leave paint lids open to dry
- Paper towels can be recycled
- Wipe down tables



Background

WINSLOW HOMER 1836-1910 (American)

Homer was born in Boston the second of three sons and grew up in Cambridge, where he led an active outdoor life. His parents both came from long lines of New Englanders and his mother, to whom he was closest, was a skillful amateur watercolorist. Even his father, a chronically unsuccessful businessman, always bought supplies and encouraged his son's art career. Winslow was expected to follow his older brother to Harvard, but elected instead an apprenticeship to Boston lithographer John H. Bufford. He spent two years there drawing sheet music covers and other commercial work. While it was the closest thing to intensive training Homer would ever have, he referred to this period as a "treadmill existence."

In 1857 he began a career as an independent free-lance graphic artist that would last the next twenty years. In 1859 he moved to New York and became the leading illustrator for Harper's Weekly, the best magazine of the time.

During the Civil War Harper's sent Homer to Virginia, where he did numerous sketches that became the basis for later oilpaintings. He began submitting canvases to the annual exhibitions at the National Academy of Design in 1863, and was elected a full Academician two years later. He had become a painter almost overnight and was virtually self-taught. In 1866 he spent ten months in France, where his painting *Prisoners from the Front* was on display. On his return he settled for the next thirteen years in New York and lived in a building with other artists including Eastman Johnson and John La Farge.

During the 1870s his subjects included themes of rural life, childhood and recreational activities, which fit the post-war nostalgia for the American past. He also began painting in various locales – the Adirondacks, Lake George and Gloucester, Massachusetts, where he first worked in watercolor.

Homer made a second trip to Europe in 1881, spending about two years in Cullercoast, a small English fishing Village on the North Sea. He worked almost exclusively in watercolor using a darker palette and developing a more fluid technique. His earlier subject matter was replaced with more serious themes treating fishing families and their relationship with the sea – often in conflict. He continued on this vein upon his return to the States.

In 1884 his reclusive nature and desire for solitude led to his move to Prout's Neck, Maine – an isolated locale where he would live the rest of his life. The house was four miles

away from the nearest railroad and telegraph; heating was never modernized (“Mop frozen stiff in the other room,” he wrote in January, 1908); he hated cars and pretended to have no knowledge of telephone usage. Understandably his travels were frequently to warmer climates like Florida, Bermuda and Cuba in order to escape the harsh Maine winters. It was in Prout’s Neck that he created the classic seascapes and themes containing unease and presentiment of death.

PIERRE AUGUSTE RENOIR 1841-1919 (French)

Auguste Renoir was a French artist who was instrumental in the development of Impressionist style. He was born to a working class family in Limoges, Haute-Vienne, France. He worked in a porcelain factory as a child. He painted designs on the china patterns. He also painted wall hangings and fans before he attended art school.

In 1862, he began to study art under Charles Gleyre in Paris, and it was there that he met Claude Monet, Alfred Sisley, and Frederic Bazille. Recognition was slow to come because of the Franco-Prussian War. He joined forces with Monet, Sisley, Pissarro and others to mount the first Impressionist exhibition in April 1874. Although the exhibit as a whole was not well received, Renoir’s paintings were comparatively well received and later that year, two of his paintings were shown in London. In 1870, after the success of his painting of Mme Charpentier and Her Children (1878) at the Salon of 1878, Renoir became a successful and fashionable painter. He traveled extensively in Algeria, Spain, and Italy.

In 1890, he married Aline Victorine Charigot, with whom he already had a son named Pierre. After his marriage Renoir painted many scenes of his family doing everyday things. He had three sons all together: Jean Renoir became a filmmaker, Pierre Renoir became a stage and film actor, and Claude Renoir became a ceramic artist.

By 1892, Renoir developed rheumatoid arthritis and he moved to a farm close to the Mediterranean Sea. He was still able to paint, but he required someone to place the brush into his hands. The wrappings of his hands seen in photos of the artist later in life were to protect his skin from irritation.

In 1919, Renoir visited the Louvre to see his paintings hanging next to the Old Masters. His work is known for its vibrant color and focus on people in intimate and candid compositions. A prolific artist, he created several thousand paintings. The single largest collection of his work, 181 paintings, is at the Barnes Foundation in Philadelphia.

CLAUDE MONET 1840-1926 (French)

Monet was one of the founders and a leading spirit on the Impressionist School. He and his friends conceived the idea of carrying into landscape and ordinary-life painting the lessons learned from Realism, I.e., creating an alternative art outside the control of the national academy which required a clear narrative and a lofty subject. Monet not only painted the world he saw around him but he painted it exactly as he saw it. What mattered to him was not what he knew about an object but the impression it made on his eyes. He seized upon the appearances of things and set them down in tiny particles of color loosely brushed on the canvas. Capturing the light, the atmosphere, was what concerned him the most.

Revision History

Revision Date	Docent Name	Comments
1984	Nancy Marston	Developed
1986		
2005		
2009		
2010	Committee lead by Reneé Marshalla	
February 2012	Kimberly Dickerson	Reformatted for continuity
February 2013	Curriculum Committee	Added suggestions for docents to give feedback to children
May 2016	Curriculum Committee	Removed candles/crayons and added white Craypas for wax resist as candles/crayons weren't leaving enough wax
April 2018	Renee Marshalla led committee	As part of the 5 year plan, emphasis was placed on art element of space. Prints were added to enhance the discussion and the experimentation was removed.
May 2019	Kimberly Dickerson	New VAPA Standards added
May 2023	Kimberly Dickerson	Typos corrected, reference to wax resist updated to reflect Caran d'Ache, test paper size changed to 3" x 11"
June 2024	Curriculum Committee	Parent Volunteer Instructions added